

Gamification & Branded Games

Component parts for launching offerings at Merkle.

JANUARY 02, 2024

YOUR MISSION

Gamification can be the key to driving behavior in the short and long-term by tapping into emotional motivations.



OFFERING SUMMARY

Gamification & Branded Games

WHAT IT IS

Gamification can be applied broadly across customer experiences to drive engagement and business results in the short and long-term.

These offerings focus on how to apply gamification recommendations at the macro and micro level, from assessing existing experiences to creating entirely new ones in a large scale game or digital experience.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- **Create new habits and behavior** at the individual level
- **Drive acquisition and engagement** within owned and outside channels
- **Improve sentiment and emotional loyalty** by increasing positive time spent with brand
- **Boost incrementality** in specific time periods
- **Improve awareness and trial** of new products, services, and brand priorities

WEDGE

Can be delivered at less than \$100k USD, to 'open the door'.

Gamification Assessment

COMING SOON

Gamification Workshop

Gamification Concepts

COMING SOON

Gamification Feature Design

ENGAGEMENTS

Are over \$100k USD that you can sell individually or together.

Gamification Blueprint

COMING SOON

Gamification Evolution
Blueprint



VALUE PROP / GROWTH & BUSINESS AGILITY

Gamification Contacts

Gamification experts across the globe with a focus on strategy and development

AMERICAS



Jen Gray

GM, Promotions &
Gamification / Creative



Kinley Clifford

VP Head of Experience
Design Consulting,
Gamification & Loyalty



Caron Whitener

SVP, Client Services
Promotions & Loyalty



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and delete this note

WHAT'S INSIDE

External Sales Narrative

Offering Definition

Market Commercial Guidance

Launch QA (for GTM team)

GTM OFFERING TOOLKIT

EXTERNAL SALES NARRATIVE

The content developed in this section will be used for external marketing and selling. It will form the core sales deck to be used in client pitches and RFP responses.

GTM OFFERING TOOLKIT / EXTERNAL ENABLEMENT TEMPLATES

Gamification & Branded Games

It's not enough to just
engage customers anymore.

You need to **empower** them.



We use gamification to do just that.

Gamification puts customers in the driver's seat by **using emotional motivation to make them *want* to engage** with your brand.



All games use gamification, but not all gamification is a game.

It's about more than the presence of badges and leaderboards —
it's the science behind *why* games motivate us.



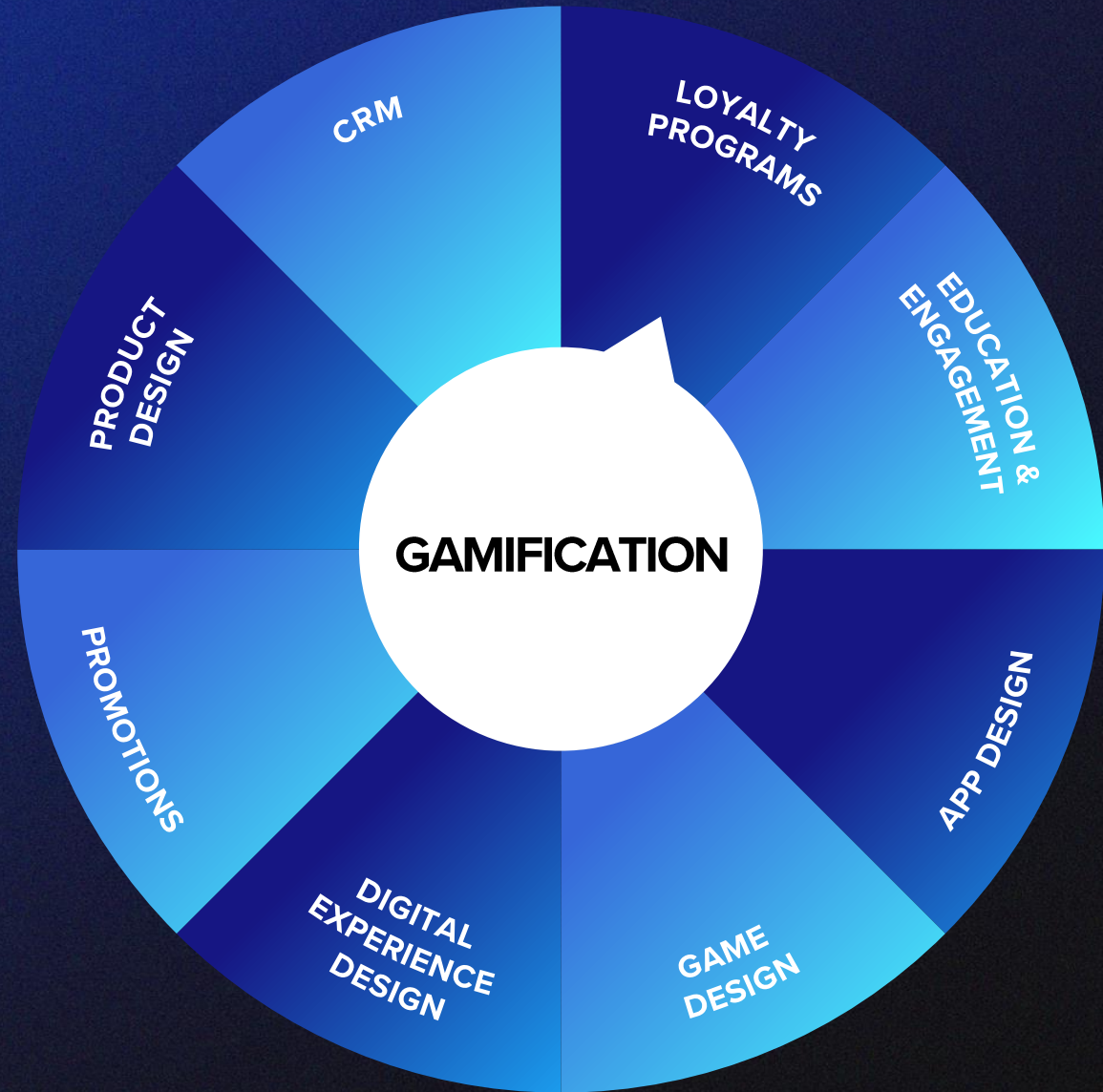
GAMES use intrinsic and extrinsic rewards and game mechanics to keep us wanting to engage and play.



GAMIFICATION takes similar elements and applies them to both game and non-game settings to encourage specific behaviors.

Gamification is one solution with almost universal relevance.

Because gamification is an engagement theory, it has broad applicability, from creating websites and apps to developing promotional campaigns or employee curriculum — really any instance where you want someone to be motivated to do something.



When done right,
gamification can be
a **powerful motivator**
of behavior in the
short and long term.

19.5%

Increase in purchase frequency in 1 month

18%

Increase in NPS within 6 months

500%

Increase in CRM database in 8 months

20%

Increase in YoY loyalty acquisition



But as the space grows, few brands are using gamification as effectively as they could be.



In **2017**, it was estimated that failed gamification projects had cost American businesses more than \$700 million in the last decade, at a time when the *global* gamification market was only valued at **\$6.8 billion**.



By **2027**, the gamification market value is projected to reach **\$521 billion**, which means tens of billions could be at risk.

The issue is that brands are applying mechanics broadly, instead of picking the right mix for their needs.

Making gamification work is easier said than done, and success is far from assured. Even major players such as Google News and Facebook, despite their size and formidable tech savvy, have failed to turn gamified elements such as badges and awards into user engagement...

Success with gamification is about more than merely creating a fun and exciting game, or one that is technically sound.



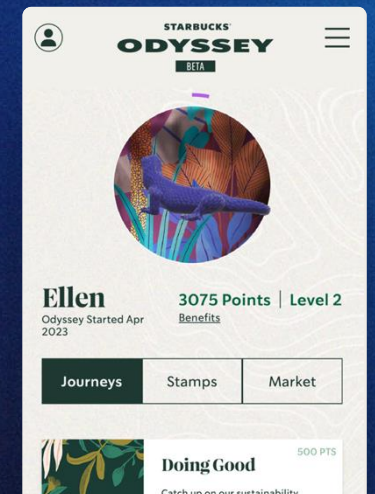
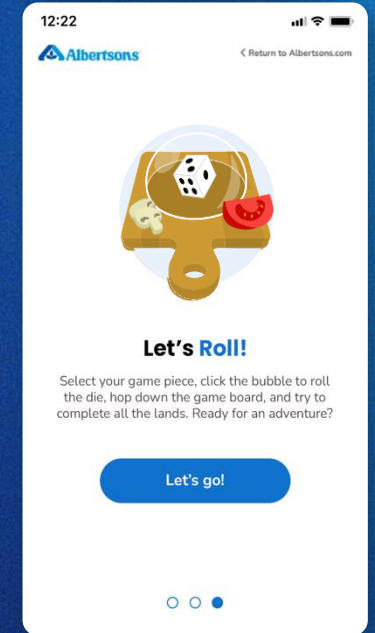
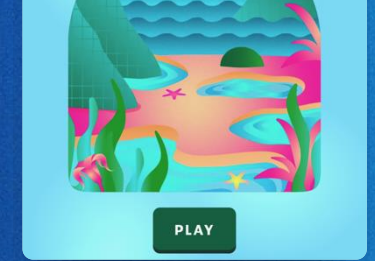
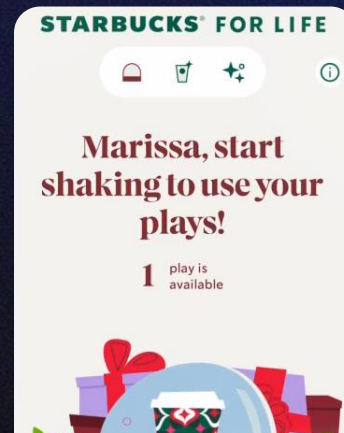
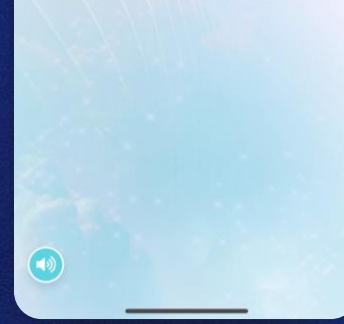
Instead, it is about bringing genuine benefits... and choosing the right approach for the aims it wants to achieve.”

**Berkeley
Haas**

—*The Business Value of Gamification*,
M. Jacobides et al, 2024

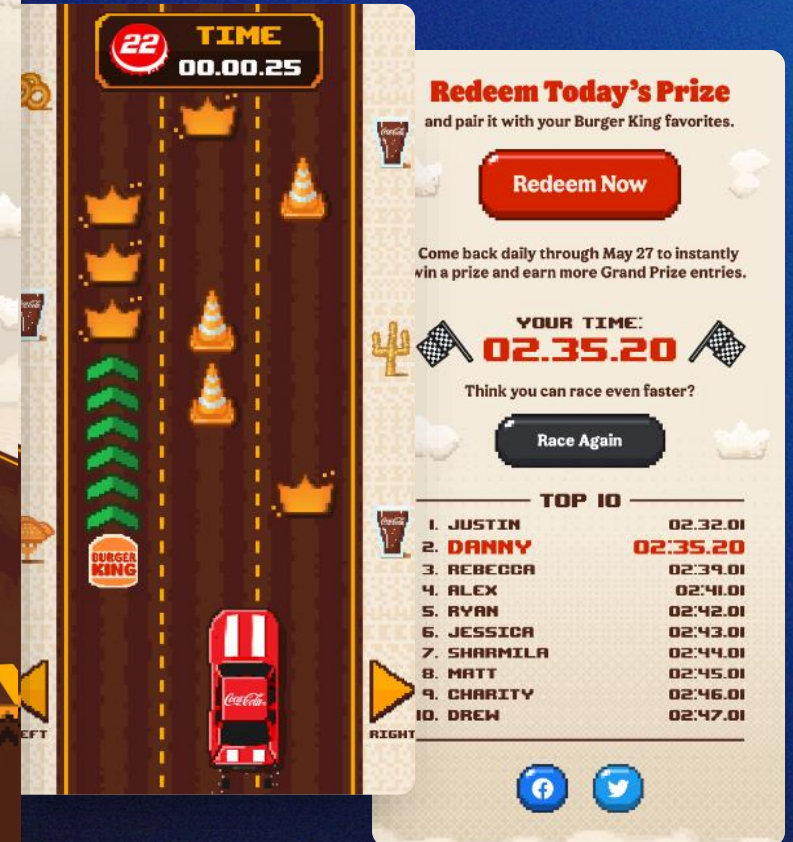
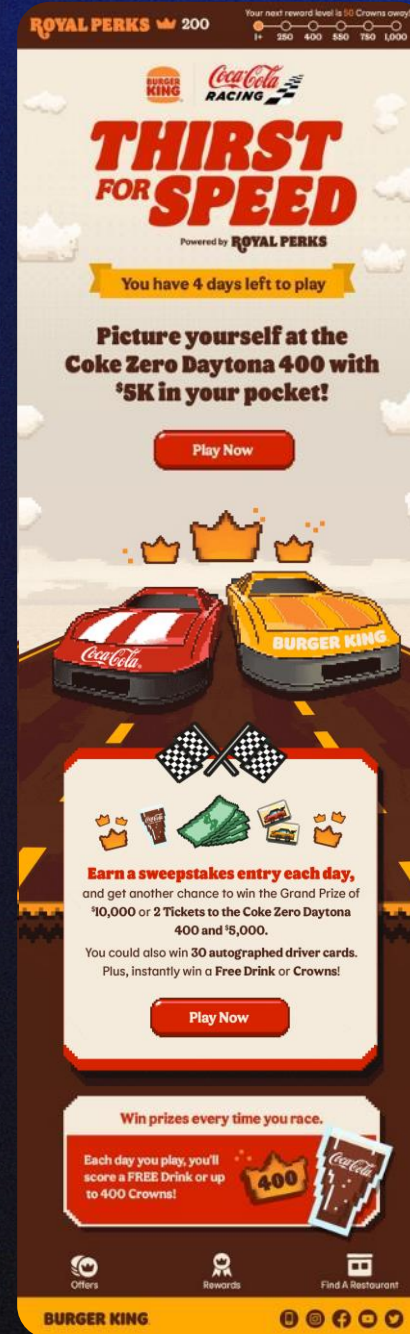
Sound
daunting?
Don't worry.

We don't just
play here —
we created
this game.

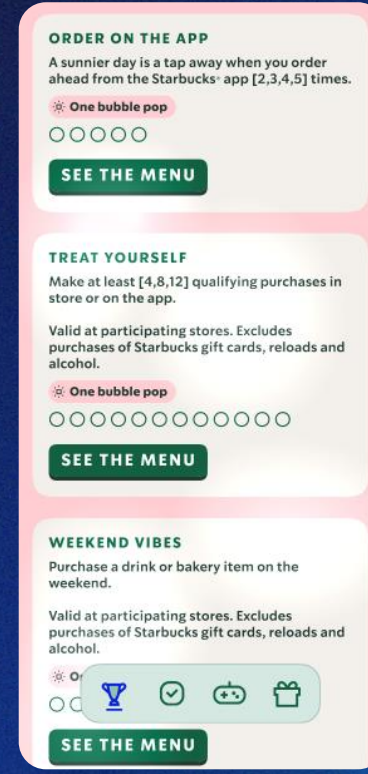
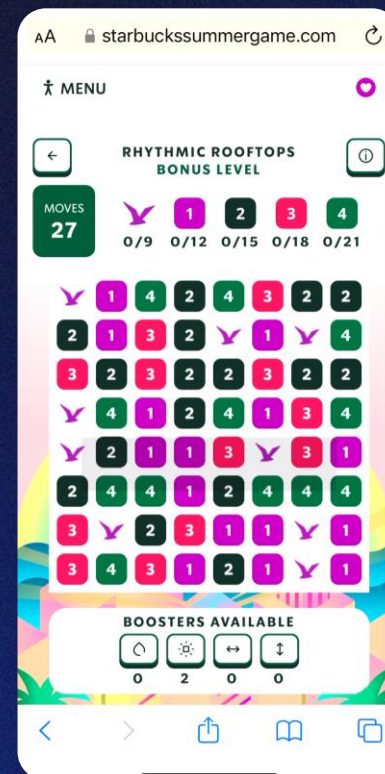
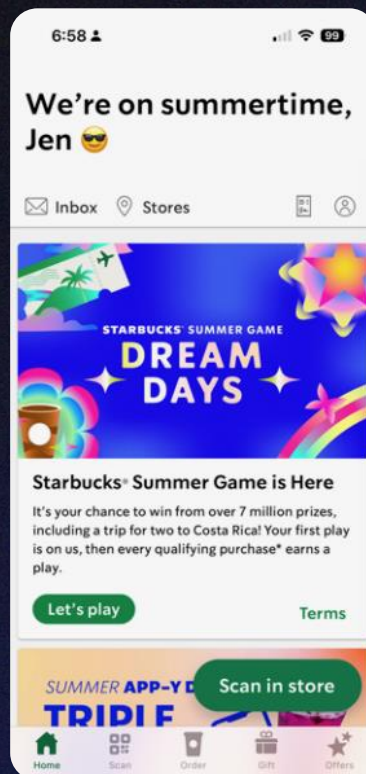


We're the original
player in the space
with **25 years of
proven experience.**

We put loyalty programs into overdrive with powerful games and overlays.



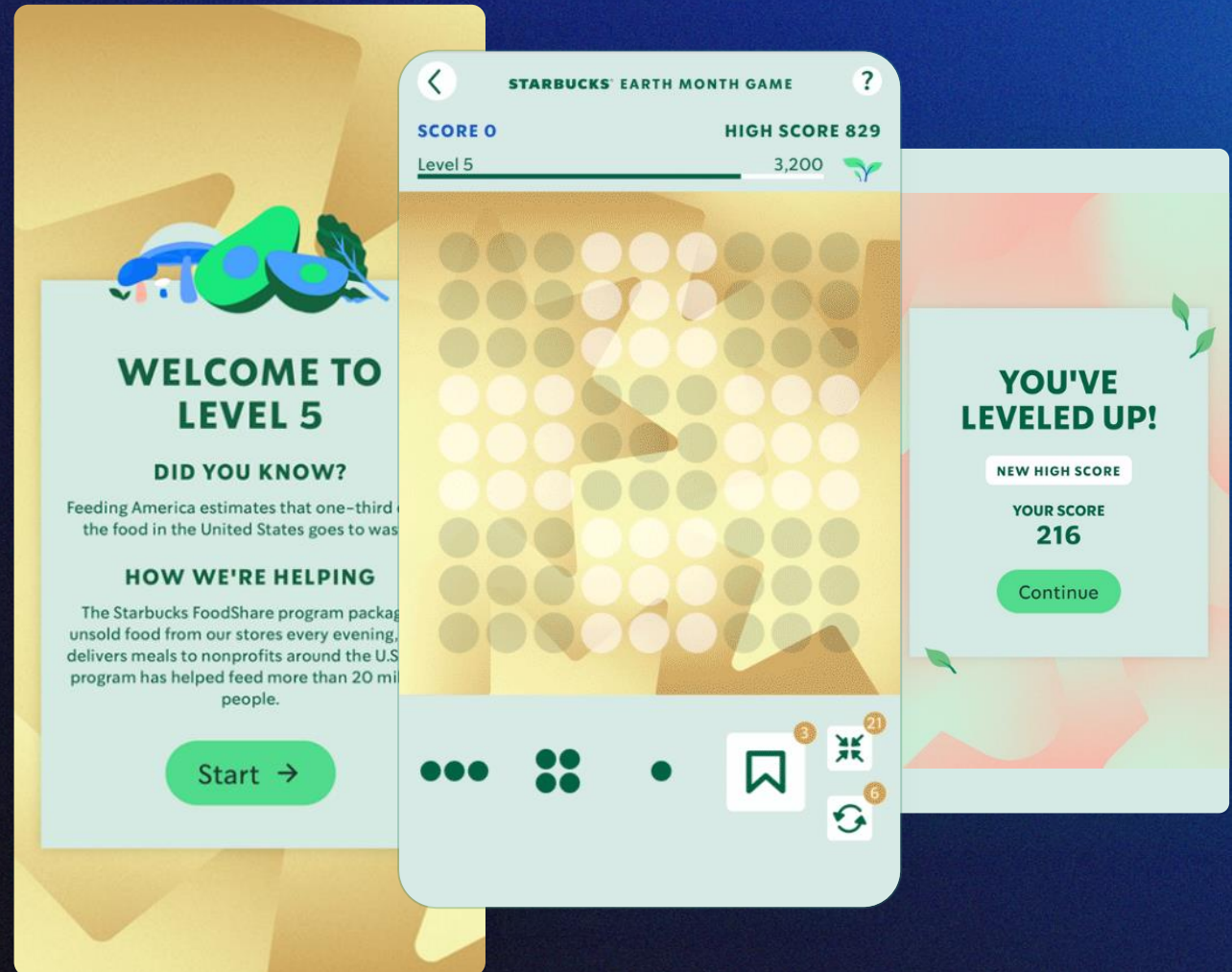
We perk up
incremental
behaviors
across
digital and
retail.



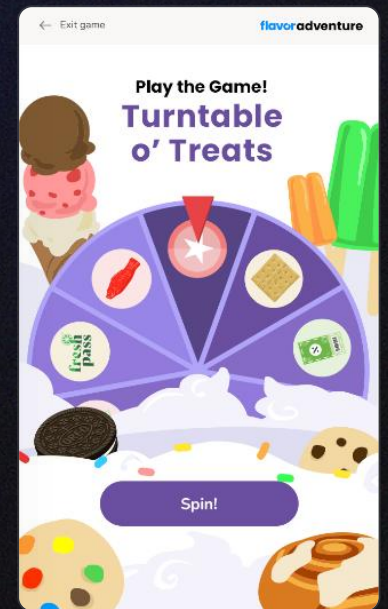
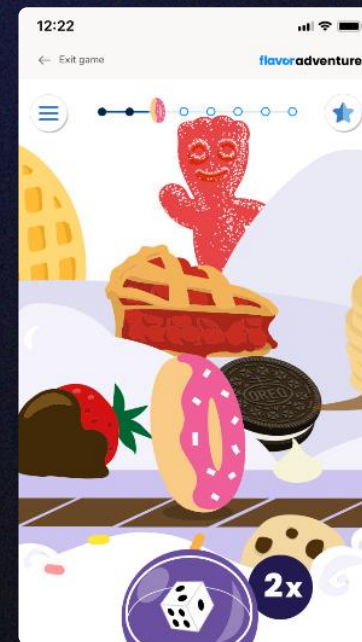
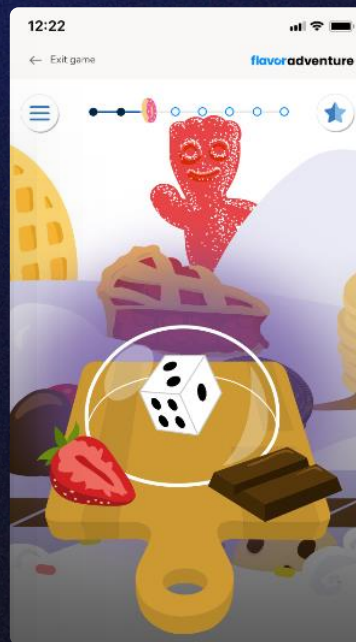
We create a home for members to run back to in pursuit of their goals.



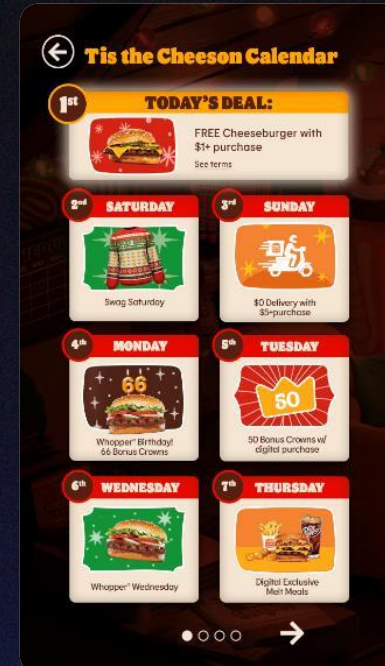
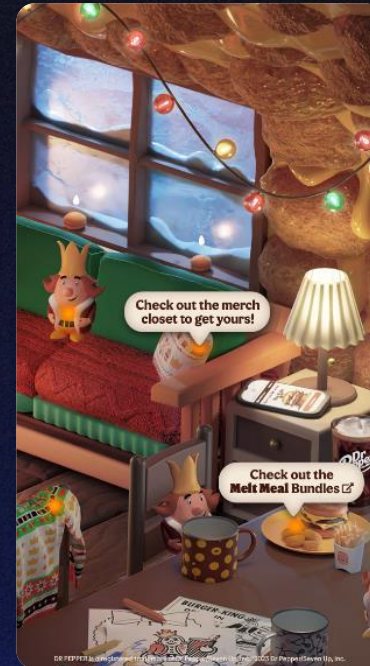
We plant the
seeds of social
consciousness
by putting players
in control.



We drive
serious
behavior
shifts with a
playful spin
on tradition.



We create
immersive
worlds that
delight while
they deliver.



And we're the only provider on the market who offers gamification as **a full-service specialty**, rather than a 'one-size-fits-all' feature set.

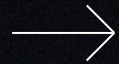


Our process uses
motivational science
to create the unique mix
of mechanics and rewards
needed to connect on a
deeper emotional level
by activating the rewards
center of the brain.



INTRINSIC MOTIVATION

Dopamine and the experience itself
shift the motivation to an internal want,
rather than external incentive



EXTRINSIC MOTIVATION

An external factor like the chance
of a reward brings the user in

Our deep understanding of motivational science helps us choose the right proven mechanics for maximum results

MOTIVATIONAL SCIENCE

Gamification Principles

Driving engagement by combining tension with game mechanics and intrinsic and extrinsic rewards



Game Theory & Behavioral Economics

Influence decisions by designing experiences to short cut cognitive and emotional factors in decision-making



Habit Loops

Create unconscious action using principles of habit building to change attitudes that can lead to frequent behavior



Game Thinking

The science of designing experiences based on the pursuit of mastery

PROVEN MECHANICS

Sweepstakes
Instant Win
Contest
Tiers
Badges

Leaderboards
Challenges
Mission
Quiz
Ratings

Scavenger Hunt
Trivia
User Generated Content
Voting
Boosters

Glowing Choice
Easter Egg
Points
Countdown Clock
Social Pressure

Dashboards
Progress Bar
Streak
Personality Test
Collect and Win

Punchcard
Progress Bar
Survey
Friending
Like

Share
Set Collecting
Feedback
Sign Posting
Virtual Currency

Skills Game
Status
Mystery Box
Tooltip
Unlocked Content

MERKLE'S

Strategic Approach to Gamification

1: DEFINE A SHARED GOAL

The solution needs a goal that encompasses what the brand wants, but adapted to answer a clear user need



2: IDENTIFY MOTIVATORS

We outline the emotional motivators that the customer is looking to fill, as well as other motivators that naturally align



3: CHOOSE MECHANICS

We concept mechanics to align with the motivators outlined above, choosing the ones that best suit our goal



4: DETERMINE REWARDS

Extrinsic rewards are offered as the carrot but also require intrinsic rewards to remain fulfilling



5: ADD TENSION

We use behavioral psychology and evolution to create a push-and-pull effect that keeps them coming back for more



We offer a range of gamification solutions to activate your customers and supercharge your business.

ENGAGEMENT
PROMOTIONS



GAMIFICATION
CONSULTING

Chance to Win

An instant gratification paired with simple purchase or engagement-based action including sweepstakes, grand prize, mini-games and more to drive signups and profile creation.

Rebate Programs

A "do, get," call to action with a guaranteed reward in exchange for the consumer's registration and participation including purchase validation, etc.

Contest

A contest in which users submit UGC or other social content to be determined the winner - a very social interaction, brings you community together.

Engagement Hub

Chance-to-win tactics combined with interactive content and engagement opportunities.

Branded Games

Games that range from templated, skill-based mini games to custom games with a deeper engagement point and a variety of behavior and purchase-driving levers.

Gamification Feature

Individual gamification features like challenges or missions that are executed alone or as part of an existing program or brand.

Gamified Ecosystem

A nuanced, experience-wide gamification effort for a loyalty program, brand, or app.

Offering Definition

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering.
The first two are a wedge, or door opener, priced to help get the the first sale.

The rest are engagements that fit various needs related to the offering.
Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.



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COMING SOON

Gamification Workshop

Gamification Concepts

COMING SOON

Gamification Feature Design

ENGAGEMENTS

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Gamification Blueprint

COMING SOON

Gamification Evolution
Blueprint

Gamification Assessment

WEDGE



OFFERING DETAILS

Gamification Assessment

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

For brands that identify areas of opportunity for how to incorporate more subtle elements of gamification and motivational science into an existing experience, app, or website

OBJECTIVE

Our gamification experts will assess the current experience using our Gamification Heuristics Scoring model, as well as deliver core areas for improvement.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

The engagement can lead to a more robust Gamification Evolution Blueprint, as well as follow on Experience Design creative, UX, and development.

CLIENT

NEW PRODUCT

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Audit of experience using Gamification Heuristics and motivational science best practices
- Analysis of UX, language, and design elements with suggested enhancements
- Document up to 10 areas of improvement, with examples of mechanics or design element recommendations included
- Prioritization of improvement areas, aligned on a scale of UX importance

MERKLE PRODUCTS & IP

- Merkle Gamification Heuristics Scoring Methodology
- Merkle Gamification Principles



Investment: \$25,000 – \$40,000
(Pricing varies on size of assessment)

Timing: 3 to 4 Weeks

Outcomes:

- Experience Audit
- Gamification Heuristics Scoring
- Opportunity Areas with Example Mechanics
- Feature Prioritization Matrix
- Gamification Prioritization Workshop (optional, additional cost)

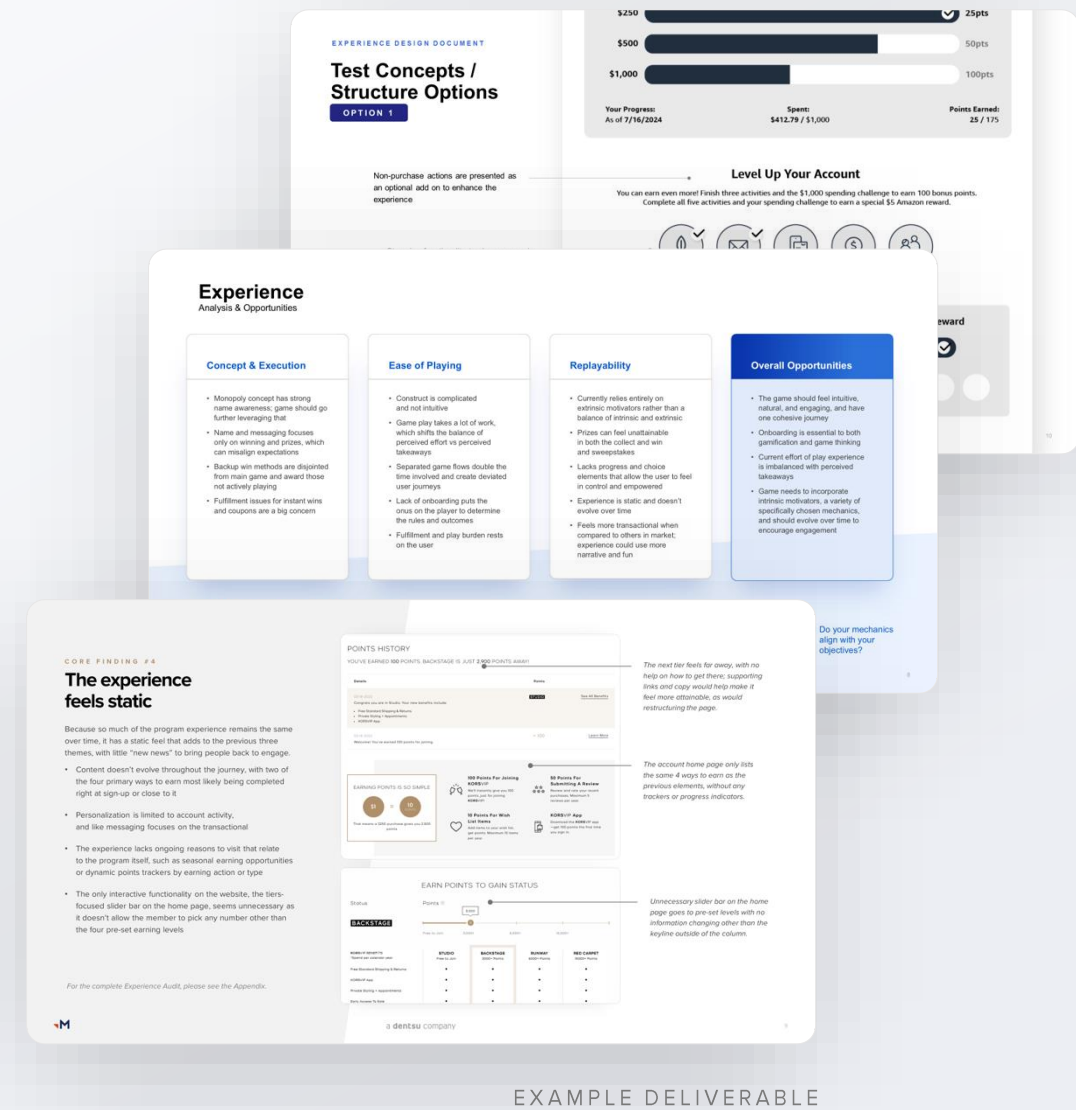
Gamification Assessment

Leverage our team of experts to evaluate and identify opportunities to weave gamification into your existing web experience, app, or loyalty program.

We will evaluate your existing experience and provide insight into places where gamification could help, as well as some high-level recommendations on how to incorporate gamification with tactical examples from the market to showcase those doing it well.

A FULL EXPERIENCE ASSESSMENT INCLUDING

-  Stakeholder Interviews
-  Competitive Assessment
-  Gamification Heuristics Scoring
-  Tactical Optimization Recommendations
-  Best in Class Mechanics Examples
-  Additional Gamification Prioritization Workshop (Add-On)



Gamification Concepts

WEDGE



OFFERING DETAILS

Gamification Concepts

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

For brands that want to take steps towards incorporating gamification into their marketing efforts

OBJECTIVE

Our gamification experts will meet with you to determine what types of behavior and goals you want to achieve, and develop 2 to 3 custom concepts to help get you there.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

The engagement can lead to development of the proposed concepts, to other consulting blueprints, or to ongoing retainer work for Strategy, Experience Design, and Creative

CLIENT

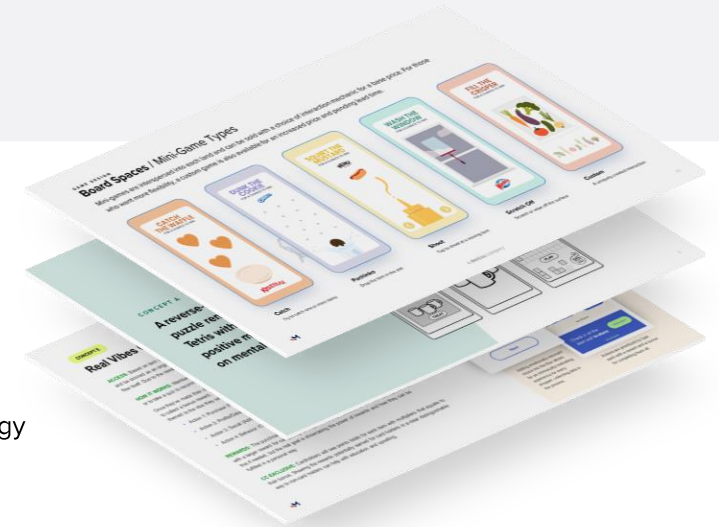
Subway, Starbucks, Burger King

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Three Gamification Concepts inclusive of a thematic wrapper, mechanics, and positioning
- Measurement Benchmarks & KPIs that showcase the potential impact of the experience
- Prizing & Rewards Ideas with guidance on reward strategy and fulfillment

MERKLE PRODUCTS & IP

- Merkle Proprietary Gamification Process



Investment: \$30,000 to \$50,000
(Please request pricing)

Timing: 3 to 4 Weeks

Outcomes:

- Gamification Concepts
- Measurement Plan & KPIs
- Prizing & Rewards Ideas

Gamification Concepts

Use gamification to drive behavior with three custom gamification concepts, all developed specifically to meet your brand’s unique needs.

From a short-term game to larger purchase driving mechanics, our gamification experts will develop three strategic concepts using proven mechanics to drive behavior and adapted to meet your unique business challenges.

A FULLY ARTICULATED PLAN INCLUDING

- 

Strategy & Opportunity Areas
- 

Executorial Roadmap
- 

Three Gamification Concepts
- 

Reward & Prizing Structure
- 

Measurement Benchmarks & KPIs



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Gamification Blueprint

PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT



OFFERING DETAILS

Gamification Blueprint

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

For brands looking to create a differentiated customer experience that drives deep connections and ongoing engagement behaviors

OBJECTIVE

Motivate brand engagement by applying techniques found in motivational science to spark emotion, create habits, and drive behavior in the short and long term

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

This engagement can lead into a full executional build of a gamified promotion or experience, or into additional Experience Design, Creative, or UX work

CLIENT

Albertsons, Starbucks, American Airlines

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Opportunity Readout
- Gamification Strategy & Vision
- Gamification Concepts & Design
- Learning Agenda & Measurement Plan
- Go To Market Plan

MERKLE PRODUCTS & IP

- Proprietary Merkle Gamification Process



Investment: \$250,000 to \$500,000
(Please request pricing)

Timing: 14 Weeks

Outcomes:

This offering delivers a complete plan and strategy to build and launch an effective gamified experience or ecosystem.

Gamification Blueprint

Create a differentiated customer experience that drives deep connections and ongoing engagement behaviors.

Using our collaborative Design Center approach, this blueprint delivers a comprehensive gamification concept, strategy and execution plan, complete with mechanics and success metrics guided by motivational science and industry best practices.

A FULLY ARTICULATED PLAN INCLUDING

- 

Strategic Plan and KPIs
- 

Innovative Gamification Concept
- 

Gamification Mechanics Design
- 

Experience Roadmap and Engagement Plan
- 

Rewards & Prizing Plan
- 

Measurement Plan & Learning Agenda

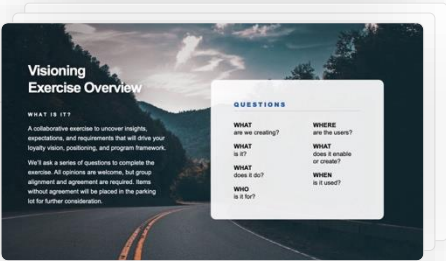


EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

An Execution-Ready Plan to Drive Business Results

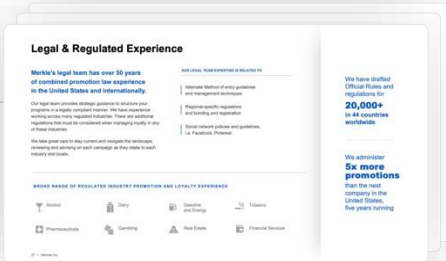
Client Discovery Workshop

Virtual session to confirm objectives, understand the opportunity, and inform tactics and ideas for the concepts.



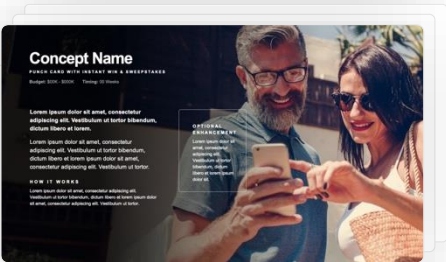
Legal and Technology Requirements

Overview of campaign-specific legal requirements and technology considerations needed to bring the experience to life.



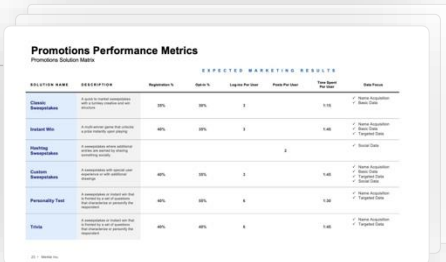
Campaign Ideas

Overview of how each concept will work, the creative theme, recommended timing/duration, KPIs, and strategic rationale.



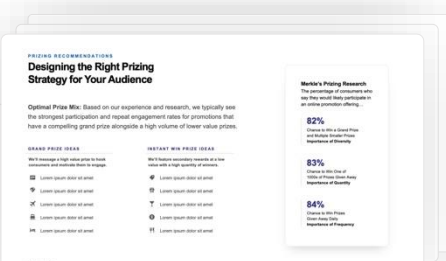
Performance Benchmarks

Expected campaign-specific performance based on Merkle's proprietary, vertical-specific benchmarks aggregated over hundreds of promotions.



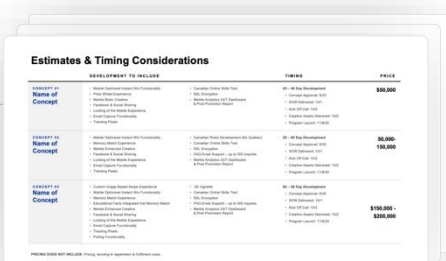
Prizing/Rewards Strategy

Prizing/rewards thought-starters and recommendations based on best practices, campaign ideas and business objectives.



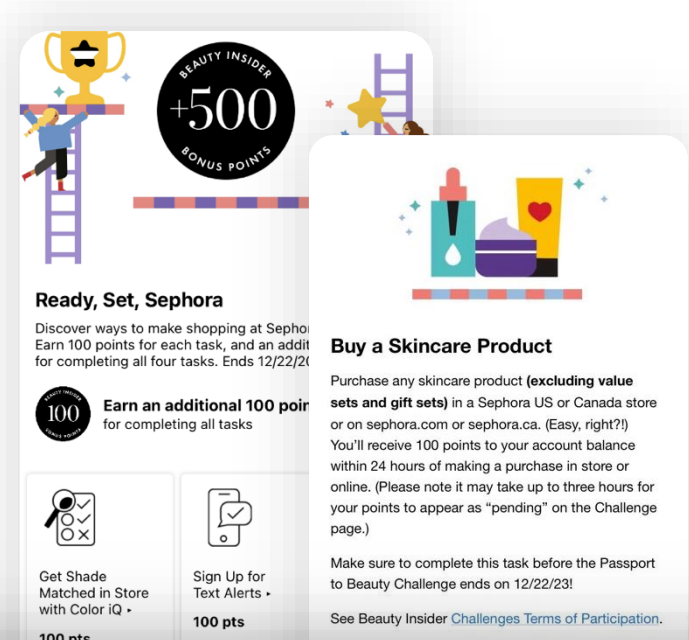
Investment and Timing

Pricing to execute the concepts and time to market ranges aligned to the specific ideas, budget, and timing considerations.



Different Types of Gamification

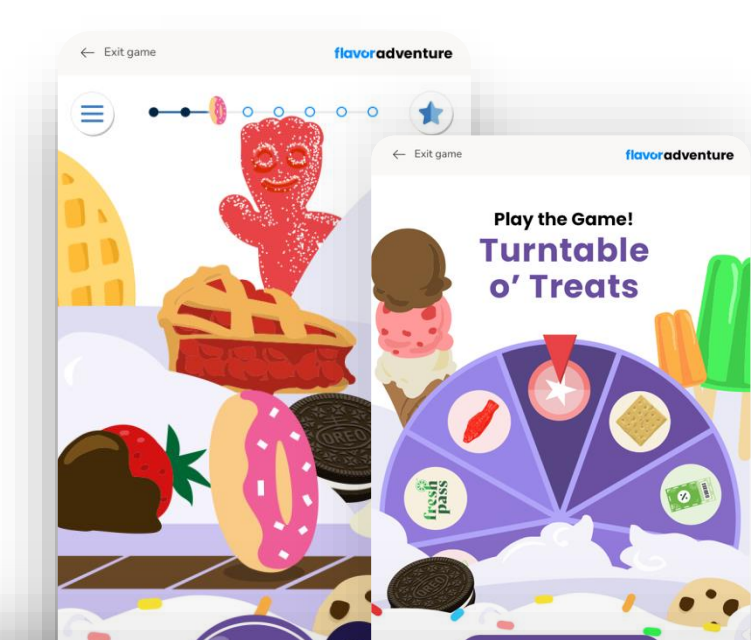
Gamification comes in many different forms, from the more traditional "game" format to more subtle habit-driving mechanics. The first question is determining which type of behavior you're trying to drive and for what time period, which then can inform a more focused approach.



SEPHORA

Implicit Gamification Is Ideal for Ongoing Engagement

Looking for an always-on or evergreen solution to change or sustain engagement or habits? Implicit gamification is the use of gamification mechanics in a less obvious way and is ideal for motivating behavior over a longer duration. It is often used to incentivize purchase, trial, and stretch behaviors with ongoing offers that are evolving over time.



Albertsons

Explicit Gamification Is Ideal for Pulsed Engagement

Explicit gamification is what most people think of when they think gamification. Shorter-duration gamified promotions can drive acquisition, engagement, and behavior over a set window, using more traditional game mechanics to inspire purchases, education, social interaction, and more.

We help leading brands drive behavior and results with gamification



The Flavor Adventure game helped boost acquisition, incrementality, and purchase of participating products while accelerating digital adoption and priority behaviors in app and in store.

100%

Funded by participating CPG partners

75%

Conversion rate



Gamification integrated with a robust CRM strategy has added heat to the brand's loyalty roll out, driving behavior in app and incrementality while boosting loyalty acquisition.

500%

Increase in loyalty & CRM database in less than eight months

19.5%

Increase in purchase frequency in just one month with integrated "Thirst for Speed" promotion



Ongoing gamification tied to loyalty drives incremental behaviors across digital and retail, spurs member trial of new products and fosters participation in brand social mission.

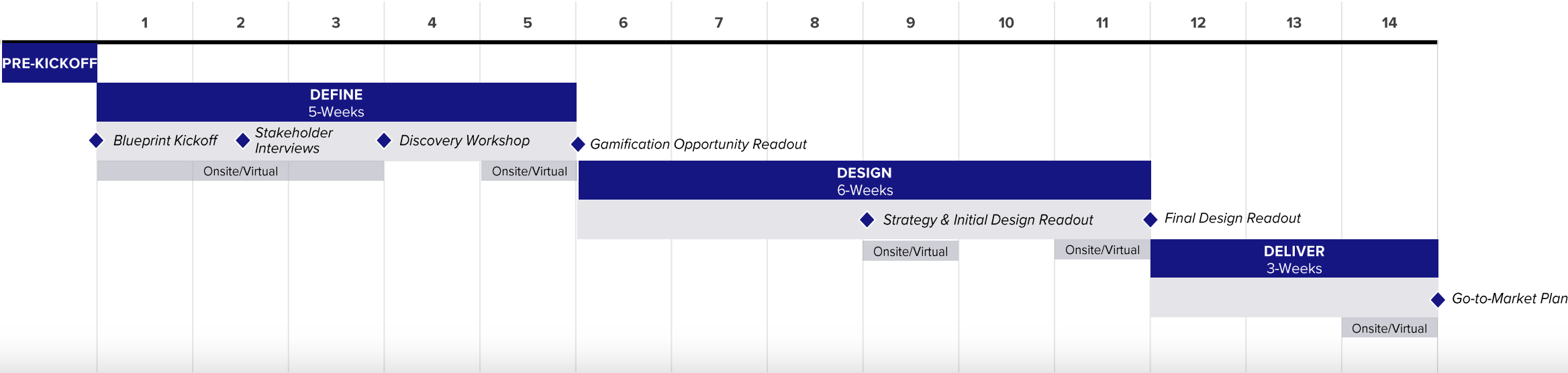
3X

Incremental revenue for seasonal games

13%

Increase in digital adoption in one year by gamifying their experience

Typical Gamification Blueprint Timing and Partnering Approach



DISCOVER

0 Weeks

- Project setup
- Planning
- Scheduling

DEFINE

5 Weeks

Merkle:

Outlines the objectives and align stakeholders to the opportunity and approach including brand, competitive, and customer research, resulting in a Gamification Opportunity readout.

Client:

Participates in stakeholder interviews and/or workshops and Gamification Opportunity readout, provides Merkle with pre-read information to immerse and onboard.

DESIGN

6 Weeks

Merkle:

Develops the strategy, program design and experience. This includes the value proposition and motivational structure, gamification concept and mechanics, prize/rewards structure, learning agenda, and overall business case development.

Client:

Provides any data needed to complete projections, participates in occasional status meetings and the Program Design readouts.

DELIVER

3 Weeks

Merkle:

Finalizes the program requirements documentation and go-to-market, inclusive of a measurement plan, ROI Projections, communications and ongoing engagement plan, prizing structure, and executive readout presentation.

Client:

Participates in workshops to finalize the any outstanding design needs, occasional status meetings, and the Go-to-Market readout.

Investment: \$xxx
Timing: 14 Weeks

Replace with specific cost

Outcomes:

This offering delivers a complete plan – everything a brand needs to build and launch an effective gamification and engagement program.



OUR APPROACH

Four steps towards a comprehensive gamification strategy

Our design-center approach can turn your aspirations into a robust executorial engagement strategy in as little as 14 weeks.

DISCOVER

0 Weeks

Pre-kickoff information gathering and administrative work, including:

- Project Setup
- Planning
- Scheduling

DEFINE

5 Weeks

Outline the objectives and align stakeholders to the opportunity and approach, including:

- Kickoff Meeting & Artifact Review
- Discovery, Gamification Readiness & Financial Modeling Workshops
- Stakeholder Interviews
- Business Immersion (brand, landscape, competitors, consumers)
- Audience Insights
- Gamification Opportunity Readout

DESIGN

6 Weeks

Develop the strategy, program experience design, and business opportunity, including:

- Strategic Plan & KPIs
- Gamification Canvas & Shared Goal
- Experience Summary
- Concept & Mechanics Overview
- Prizing/Rewards Strategy
- Learning Agenda

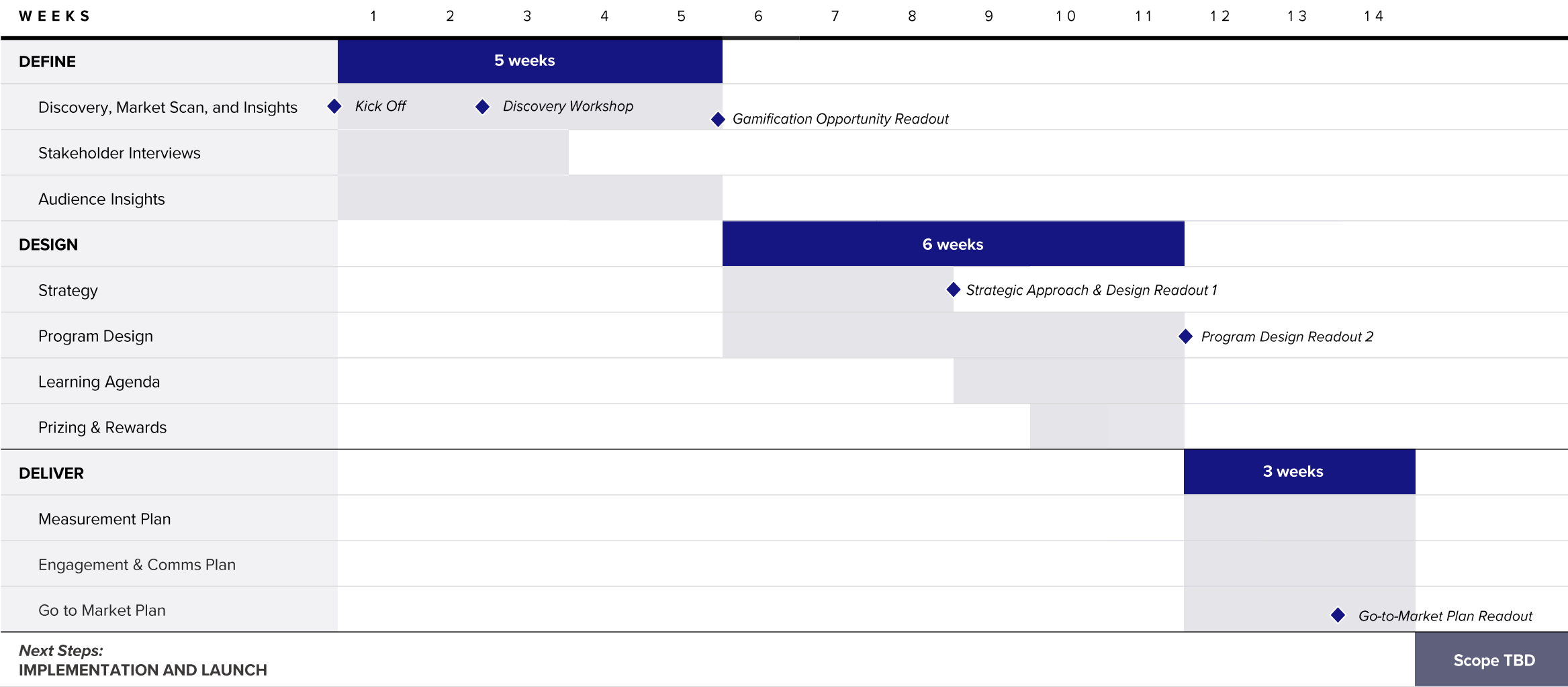
DELIVER

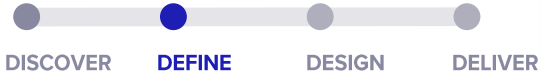
3 Weeks

Program requirements and Go-to-Market Plan, including:

- Measurement Plan
- ROI Projections
- Prizing/Rewards Structure
- Gamification Playbook/Engagement Plan
- Communications Plan
- Rough Order of Magnitude

Typical Gamification Blueprint Timing and Partnering Approach





GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DEFINE

We'll dig deep into market and cultural trends, as well as the state of both your business and your customer to uncover the white space where the most impactful gamification execution will live.

Description and Activities

Within this stage, we will cover several activities that will enable us to help guide the project and define the goals and key requirements to deliver the gamification strategy and plan.

- Project setup and kick-off meeting
- Stakeholder interviews with key representatives of the organization (Marketing, Digital, Data/Analytics, Product, Marketing, Tech, Creative/Brand, etc)
- Audience insights which can be gained via provided customer segments, survey, empathy mapping, or Merkury analysis
- Client Discovery Workshop focusing on priorities, potential challenge and opportunity points, moments mapping, and the business landscape
- Market scan of trends and executions, focusing on the industry or best in class examples
- Gamification Opportunity Readout, a presentation of the key findings and white space to focus the gamification efforts on

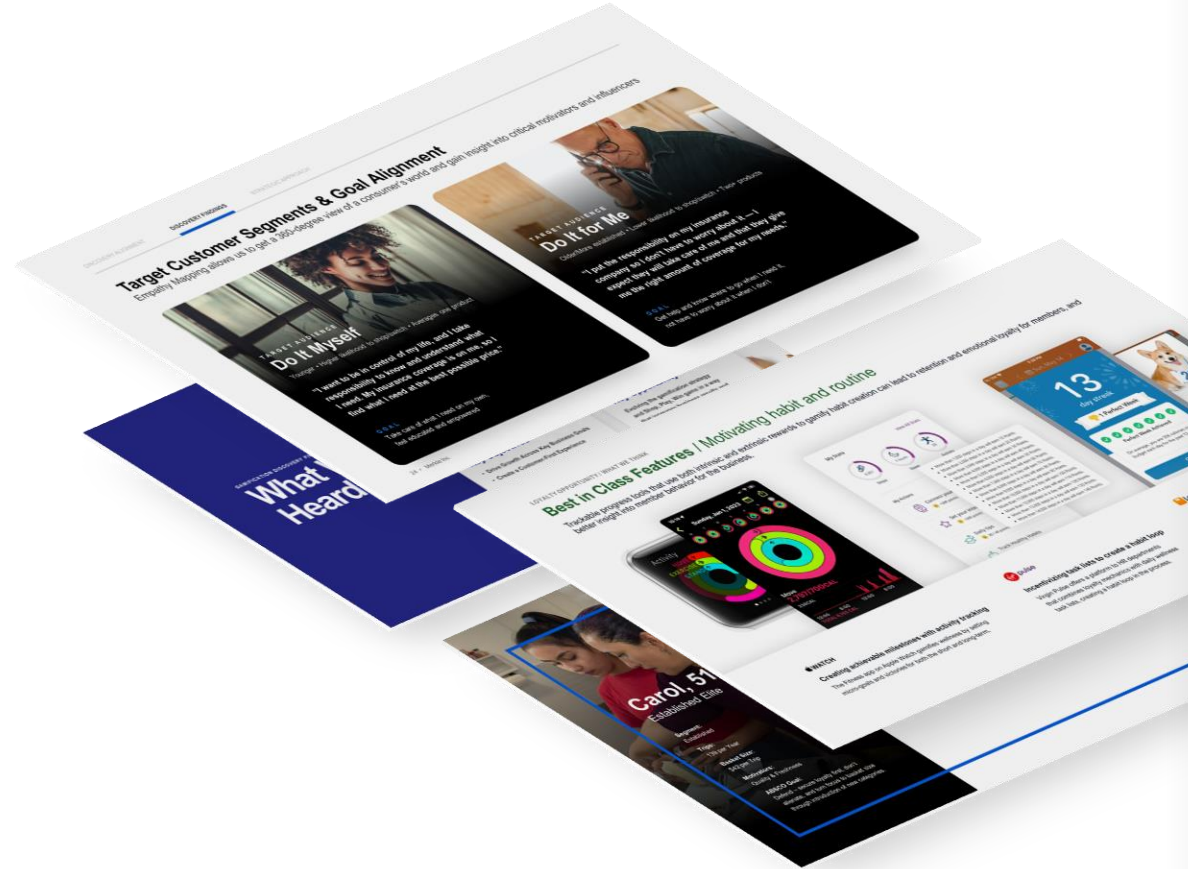
Outputs

- Project setup documentation
- Recording project kick-off meeting
- Documentation of stakeholder interviews
- Audience insights, personas, or empathy mapping
- Discovery Workshop Recap and exercises
- Market scan of 4 to 6 brands or feature sets
- Gamification Opportunity Document summarizing the above

GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DEFINE

We'll dig deep into market and cultural trends, as well as the state of both your business and your customer to uncover the white space where the most impactful gamification execution will live.



OUTPUTS

- Gamification Opportunity Readout
 - Stakeholder Interviews
 - Discovery Workshop
 - Market Scan
 - Audience Insights



GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DESIGN

We'll define the foundational strategy of the gamification program, as well as outline the program concept, design and mechanics and how they work together to achieve results.

Description and Activities

This stage outlines both the key strategy and the experience design of the gamification strategy. It includes both short and long-term strategic planning, as well as concepts and structural overviews focusing on the main components of the design.

- Strategic Vision (VSEM): A 'strategy on a page' outline that covers the strategic vision, foundational pillars, executional methods, and metrics of the campaign
- Gamification Canvas: Our proprietary gamification strategy on a page, showcasing the Shared Goal, primary motivations, and subsequent selected mechanics
- Experience Summary: Includes gamification concept, positioning and value prop, how the concept works, and feature summary, with an outline of the core mechanics and interaction points.
- This phase is usually divided into two readouts; the first covering the strategy and initial thought-starters, and the second with a more detailed look at the program and member experience

Outputs

- Strategic Plan & KPIs featuring a VSEM (Vision, Strategy, Execution, and Measures)
- Gamification Canvas & Shared Goal featuring Merkle's Proprietary Gamification Process
- Experience Summary, including program name and positioning concepts, as well as value prop
- Concept & Mechanics Overview with How it Works summary and accompanying details and visuals
- Prizing/Rewards Strategy with recommendations of suggested items and awarding cadence
- Learning Agenda with a first look at the metrics we'll want to track

GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DESIGN

We'll architect a robust gamification business and experience strategy, as well as program structure, value proposition, and mechanics overview to help bring it to life.



OUTPUTS

- Strategic Plan & KPIs
- Gamification Canvas & Shared Goal
- Experience Summary
- Concept & Mechanics Overview
- Prizing/Rewards Strategy
- Learning Agenda



GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DELIVER

We'll document the components needed to bring the gamification program to market, with details on financial impact, engagement roadmap, and executional requirements.

Description and Activities

This stage outlines the required details needed to move the project into development. It includes:

- Measurement Plan and ROI Projections for the program using our best practice benchmarks and provided client data
- Prizing and Rewards structure inclusive of recommended items, quantities, and fulfillment requirements
- Gamification Roadmap/Engagement Plan outlining the core components of engagement, as well as timing and executional considerations
- A Communications Plan outlining an overarching communication strategy as well as recommendations on how and when to communicate about the program
- A Rough Order of Magnitude which documents the priority of implementation, as well as potential staffing or resourcing considerations
- Additional conversations may be needed internally or externally at this stage to help craft a plan for moving into implementation, particularly in terms of bridge or implementation estimating and technical requirements

Outputs

A Go to Market Readout including:

- Measurement Plan
- ROI Projections
- Prizing/Rewards Structure
- Gamification Playbook/Engagement Plan
- Communications Plan
- Rough Order of Magnitude

GAMIFICATION BLUEPRINT

DELIVER

We'll outline the path forward to bringing the gamification program to market, including measurement and financial projections, engagement and communications plans, and operational priorities.



OUTPUTS

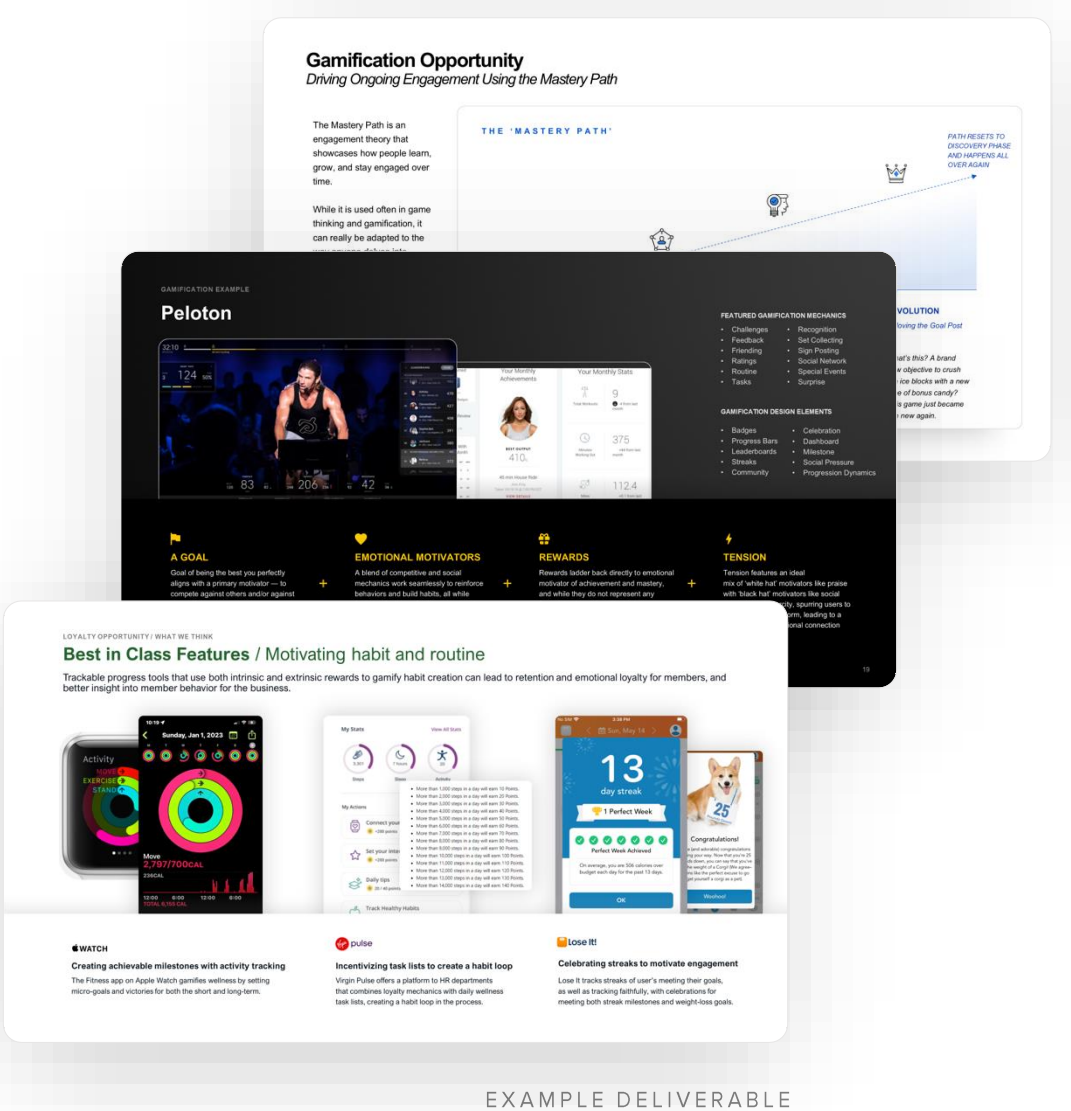
- Measurement Plan
- ROI Projections
- Prizing/Rewards Structure
- Gamification Playbook/Engagement Plan
- Communications Plan
- Rough Order of Magnitude

Gamification Market Scan Desk Research

Outlines features of note for consideration, based on our deep expertise in motivational science.

INCLUDES

- Competitive Research
- Best-in-Class Examples
- Areas of Opportunity

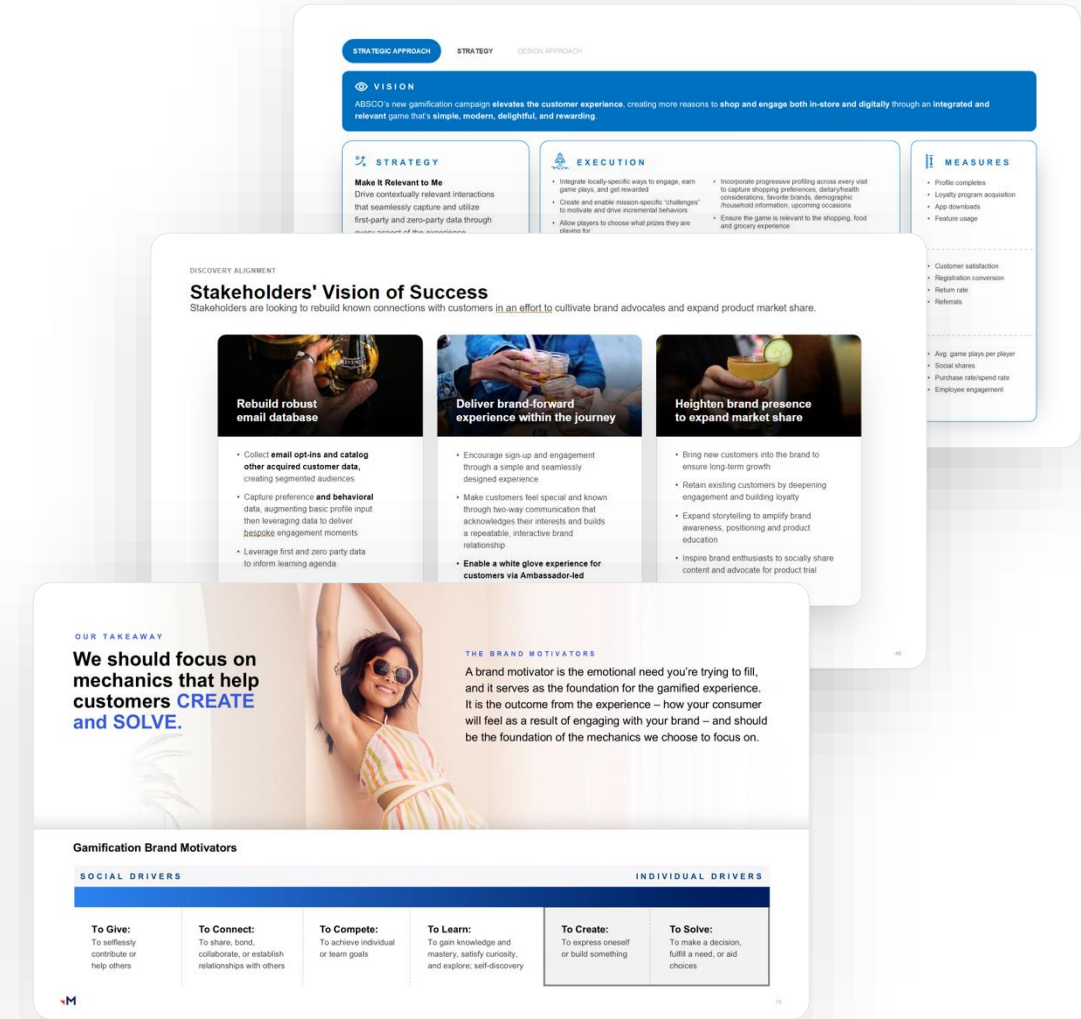


Strategic Vision and Plan Gamification Foundations

Defines the foundational strategies that provide the framework to design gamification campaigns and the foundation to scale it for long term success.

INCLUDES

- Competitive Research
- Best-in-Class Examples
- Areas of Opportunity



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Gamification Experience Summary

Mechanics and Concept Overview

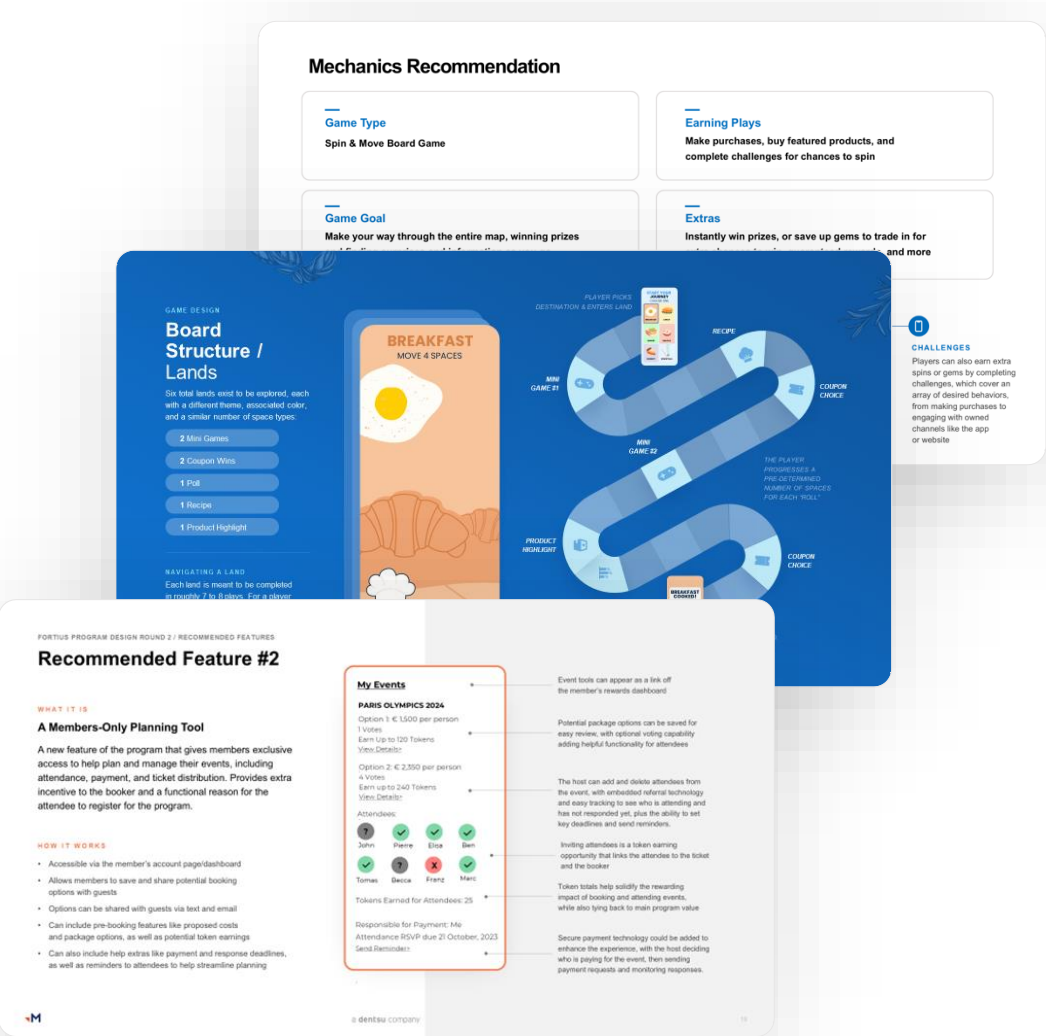
Building the framework for engagement by defining the program mechanics and overall structure. This phase includes outlining the structural elements and benefits of the program value proposition and experience.

INCLUDES

- Campaign concept and customer-facing expression
- Gamification structure
- Feature overviews

QUESTIONS TO ANSWER

- What is the most effective combination of mechanics for each business objective?
- What message and framework will be the most compelling to our end user?
- How is this program differentiated in the market place?



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Gamification Engagement Plan

Features, Activation, and Execution

Building the framework for engagement by outlining the required features and how they are activated and maintained over the duration of the program.

MAY INCLUDE

- Engagement Journey
- Engagement Guidance by Phase of the Journey
- Feature Activation
- Concept Summary and Activation Points

Gamification: Content Plan
Challenges are designed to be flexible and scalable, with the ability to target segments, leverage a multitude of mechanics, and deliver both intrinsic and extrinsic rewards to drive desired behaviors.

ENGAGEMENT & COMMS PLAN / ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY

Activate / Special Feature Considerations

The bulk of the member experience falls into this category. The focus should be on keeping members actively engaging and earning, with a variety of activities and events planned to add variety and depth to the program. **For the complete view of features, please see the Features Detail section.**

FEATURE	DETAILS
Bonus Promotions Special earning opportunities that can include points bonuses, special rewards, or deals.	Primarily ad-hoc and scheduled earning opportunities tied to product launches, specific time periods, or creative themes; these include bonus points earning, SKU Bonuses and more.
Challenges Specific behavior focused activities that include either a singular or multi-step action and associated personal utility, or specific state for	Suggested timing is 2x per month, with one challenge starting every other week or both starting on the same day of the month; challenge time limits should be determined based on the difficulty of completion. See more info in the Challenges section.

EARNING & REDEMPTION

Gamification Concept Summary / Create Milestone Moments

AUDIENCE	CONSUMER GOAL	SHARED GOAL	BRAND ENGAGEMENT DRIVERS
Rewards Members – New and experienced	"Help me see and feel the value of my investment"	Experience intrinsic value in moments beyond transactions	To Learn To gain knowledge and mastery, satisfy curiosity, and explore, self-discovery
TARGET BEHAVIOR More sustained and frequent redemption of rewards	BUSINESS GOAL Drive active engagement		To Solve To make a decision, fulfil a need, or aid choices

ENGAGEMENT MECHANICS	TENSION MECHANICS	DESIGN ELEMENTS	EXTRINSIC REWARDS	INTRINSIC REWARDS
• Routine • Task • Challenge	• Booster • Goals • FOMO • Choice	• Celebration • Beginners Luck • Missions • Unlocked Content • Time Dependent Rewards • Variable Ratio Reward Schedule	• Currency • Offers • Recognition • Achievement • Special Content	• Curiosity • Mastery • Purpose

FF2021 GOALS BRAND PILLARS ENGAGEMENT PROJECTIONS

Assumptions
Lorem

Activation/Content Plan

	FEATURE	REWARD	REWARD	REWARD
Onboarding	Step 1: Welcome	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Step 2: Explore	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Step 3: Engage	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Task Based	Task 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Task 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Task 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Quest Type	Quest 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Quest 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Quest 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Achievement	Achievement 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Achievement 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Achievement 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Challenge	Challenge 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Challenge 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Challenge 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Reward	Reward 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Reward 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Reward 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Feature Activation	Feature 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Feature Activation	Feature 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
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	Feature 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
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	Feature 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
Feature Activation	Feature 1: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 2: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points
	Feature 3: Complete Profile	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points	1000 Bonus Points

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EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Measurement Plan

Identifies, organizes, and prioritizes metrics to prove gamification campaign impact relative to goals, KPIs, and tactics.

OUTCOMES

- Defines supporting metrics to shed light on performance with respect to KPIs
- Identifies the relative success of different tactics to determine if goals are achieved
- Defines, organizes, and prioritizes data required to be able to create all metrics to measure success

Data Strategy Document

PURPOSE

This document includes Merkle's recommendation to maximize the value of data to be captured through your new Loyalty Program. By following our guidance toward the ideal state described within, your team will enrich its knowledge of the business and your consumers through actionable reports and insightful analyses.

All content is based on Merkle best practice, our experience with previous similar implementations, as well as synthesis of the Goodwill team's essential inputs collected during discovery, workshops, and reviews.

Capture Methods
Gather the Building Blocks for Insight

The section describes the primary methods to be used to capture data as well as intended use cases. In addition to the methods, this section provides a view of the different data categories and respective attributes captured from users via forms or other engagement mechanisms.

Measurement Plan
Align on What Matters

The Measurement Plan represents our recommendation for the metrics to be featured in reports throughout the program's lifespan. Selections are based on our training session and our experience with delivering insights for multiple clients. This is a living document that should be re-evaluated quarterly.

MEASUREMENT

MyPanera: Measuring to Program Objectives

Starting with your business and program objectives, our approach defines KPIs that measure those objectives through the lens of promotional tactics. KPIs will indicate whether and how the program is succeeding while metrics identify drivers of and headwinds to success, informing improvements and optimization.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVE	PROGRAM OBJECTIVES	KPI	METRICS
Build brand love and value through brand engagement that adds relevant value to MyPanera membership.	Reengage Lapsed Members Drive New Member Signups Build and Enrich Member Profiles	Higher Retention and Engagement Stronger Growth in New Membership More Profile Attributes Complete	Retention Rate of active users Re-engagement rates/volumes of lapsed and dormant New Member (Acquisition) volume New Members onboard rate "Core" profile completion rate Average profile % complete with attributes desired

Business Objective	Program Objective	Program Tactics	Metric Category	Metric Sub-Category	Metric Detail	Metric Type	Responsibility	Unit	Measurement Period	Notes
Maximize AdvantEdge member engagement throughout the lifetime of the program	Acquire consumers into the AdvantEdge program	New AdvantEdge Member Lift	Member Lift	New AdvantEdge Members signed up during promotion	New AdvantEdge Members during promo who were referred from email	Support	AA / Merkle	# (count)	10/1/2024 - 9/30/2025	Based on email
					Number of inactive AdvantEdge Members reactivated	Support	AA	# (count)		
					Total Registrations	KPI	Merkle	# (count)	2.0M	
	Drive excitement through a fun and celebratory theme (Offer a variety of engagement elements that appeal to everyone)	Engagement Rate by Activity	Registration	Logins per user	Total 1M Free Earned	Support	Merkle	# (count)		
					Total 1M Free Used	Support	Merkle	# (count)		
					% Used vs. Earned 1M Free	Support	Merkle	%	4.5	
					Total Sweepstakes Entries	Support	Merkle	# (count)		
					Sweepstakes Entries per user	KPI	Merkle	# (count)	25,000 per participant	
	Refresh engagement activities on a weekly basis	Return Rate	Return Rate	% Users who returned at least once following their registration week	% Users who returned at least once	Support	Merkle	%	27.0%	
					% Users who returned twice, separate weeks following their registration	Support	Merkle	%		
Drive AdvantEdge member participation	Leverage the member community to inspire one another	Social Shares	Clicks to "Fun Fun" Share Button/Post	Total number of email shares	% Users who participated at least once in "Fun Fun" shares	Support	Merkle	%	1.4%	
					Number of shares per user (who shared at least once)	KPI	Merkle	# (count)	2.5	MyPanera.com/advantedge
					Email Share Conversions to Registration	Support	Merkle	# (count)		
	Inspire AdvantEdge members to travel confidently and dream about future trips	Clicks to Weekly Social Challenge (Instagram, TikTok)	Clicks to Weekly Social Challenge (Instagram, TikTok)	Total Weekly Social Challenge clicks (Twitter, Instagram)	% Users who participated at least once in Weekly Social Challenge	Support	Merkle	%	5.4%	
					Number of shares per user (who shared at least once)	KPI	Merkle	# (count)	1.3	MyPanera.com/advantedge
					% Users who participated at least once in daily facts (clicked to view)	KPI	Merkle	%	10.0%	
					Number of daily facts per user (who clicked facts at least once)	Support	Merkle	# (count)		

EXAMPLE DELIVERABLE

GTM OFFERING TOOLKIT

Market Commercial Enablement

The content developed in this section will be used for internal training and education purposes. This is needed to provide sellers with the necessary context and information to successfully sell the offering.

GTM OFFERING TOOLKIT / INTERNAL ENABLEMENT TEMPLATES

Gamification & Branded Games

LEARN THE OFFERING

01

Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

02

Pricing & Commercial Guidance

Guidance on pricepoint, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

03

Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

04

Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

05

SME Contacts

Have questions? Reach out to the offering owner or regional point person. They can help you present or tailor this content for your needs.

OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

Marketing Leader: Brand Manager, Digital Marketing Manager, VP Marketing, Head of CRM/Loyalty

Charged with knowing customers, building relationships, creating differentiated experiences for customers, and driving sales and growth for the brand.

Collect Data

Owning first-party consumer data that fuels future interactions.

Drive Behavior

Motivating people to make purchase and engagement actions.

Build Loyalty

Creating moments of value that build relationships and long-term loyalty.

PEERS & INFLUENCERS

Legal

Need to minimize risk and seek experts in what's compliant.

Procurement

Responding to price pressure and "doing more with less."

Tech

Looking for easy integrations and partners that keep data secure and mitigate fraud.

PRIMARY OUTCOMES

Help sellers and client partners understand how the offering drives key business outcomes for this buyer. Where possible, highlight measurable performance drivers that speak to growth, cost management/profitability, or risk management.

Outcome	Why it Matters
Database Growth / Data Collection	Brands must own 1PD/ZPD to understand their consumers and foster long-term relationships. Gamification can drive new sign-ups, data/profile collection, and opt-ins for future marketing.
Customer Engagement	Gamification is often tied to large brand initiatives (product launch, partnership, huge media campaign, etc.) so brands can ensure target customers are aware across channels, engaging with the brand, and motivated to take action.
Time Spent with Brand	Compelling experiences drive awareness and consideration for the brand and new products/solutions. Multiple return visits and several minutes of engagement show "quality time" being spent.
ROI	Need to tie promotion/engagement activities to ROI and outcomes they drive for the business. Client data maturity varies widely – some focus on baseline metrics only, but others need our help to be mature in their data collection and metrics.

OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

TARGET INDUSTRIES

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

Industry	Why it Matters	What to listen for	Do we have vertical-specific content?
CPG	Brands often lack direct relationships to consumers and the data needed to know their customers.	Database growth, owning 1PD/ZPD, Shopper Marketing, direct-to-consumer initiatives	Yes
Retail	Gamification can help retailers drive purchase without across-the-board discounts and engage with customers between purchases.	Customer journey optimization, incrementality, offer/incentive personalization, Shopper Marketing, retail media network, loyalty sign-ups and engagement	Yes
Restaurant/QSR	Restaurants use gamification to drive incrementality, to highlight co-marketing with partners, sponsorships, and new menu items, as well as part of loyalty programs.	Database growth, incrementality, new partnerships, co-marketing, sponsorships, product-launches, customer journey optimization, loyalty sign-ups and engagement	Yes
Travel/Hospitality	Brands use gamification to drive exploration of new destinations/properties and to collect user-generated content that can serve as testimonial	Need to increase bookings, launching new property, want word of mouth/referral, loyalty sign-ups and engagement, user-generated content	Yes
Financial Services	Gamification can educate customers, acquire new ones, and help determine the right products/services based on profile, as well as habitualize behavior	Customer acquisition, new products/services, awareness/education, journey optimization, motivating behaviors	No
Media/Entertainment	Gamification can support engagement and usage of content or digital experiences, and lower cost of acquisition when coupled with other media approaches and help drive awareness of new shows/movies/games.	Acquisition/ database growth, awareness-building, fan engagement, new launches	Yes

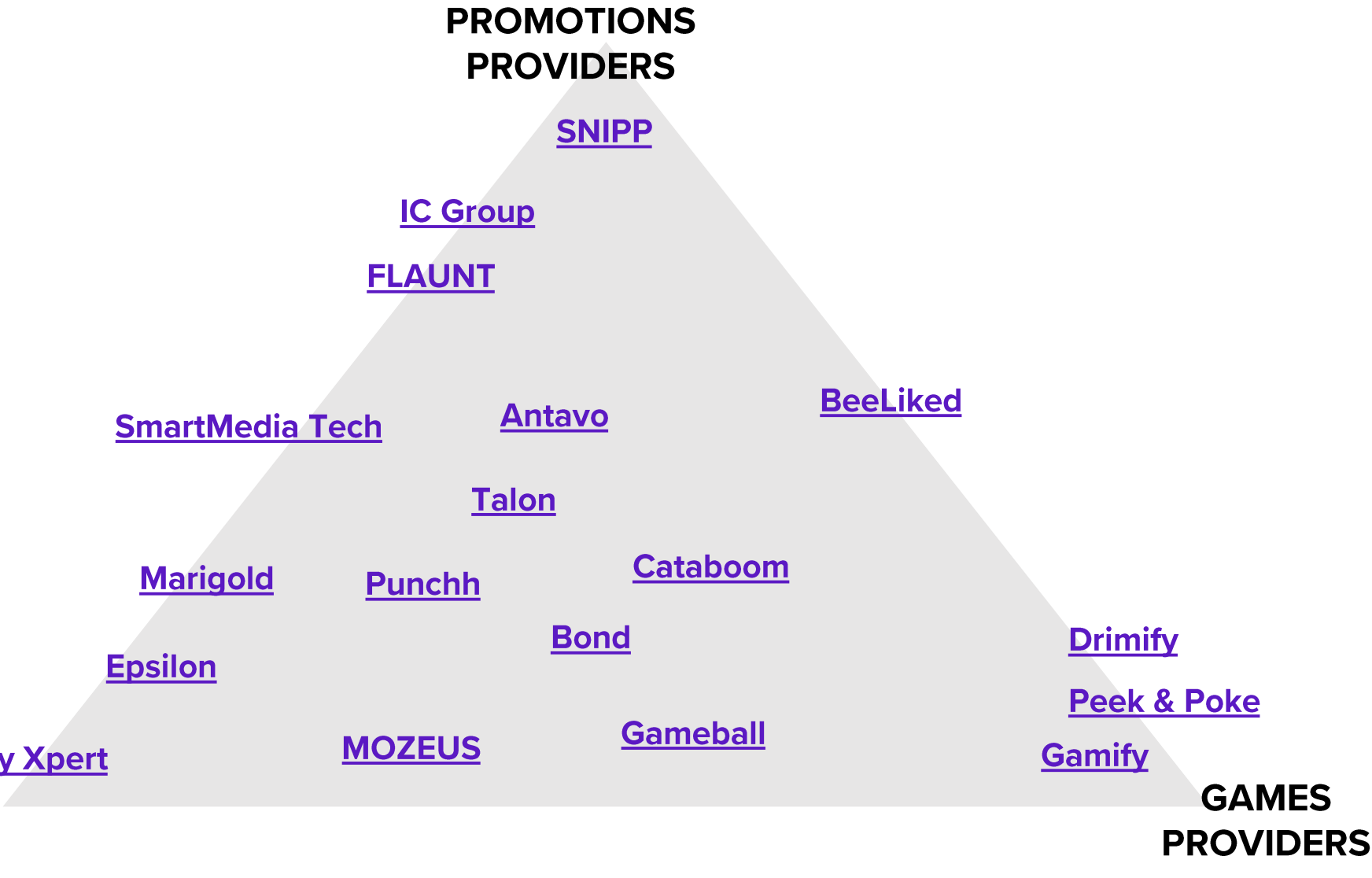


OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games

Commercial Guidance

Brands can use gamification to spark engagement with their consumers, collect data, and drive desired behaviors across the customer journey. Many providers who offer gamification do so as part of a larger suite of loyalty and/or promotions capabilities, or are stand-alone features providers with out of the box ‘games’ that come standard. Please click through to view each company’s site.



OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on pricepoint, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

Client-facing pricing slides for each engagement can be found on the following slides.

ABOUT THE MARKET

Who it's for	Brands can use gamification to spark engagement with their consumers, collect data, and drive desired behaviors across the customer journey.		Size of Market for these services.	\$00	INTEREST
Key competitors	Marigold Engage (Formerly Cheetah Digital) “Grow” platform includes SaaS interactive experiences with 85+ templates to quickly capture ZPD/IPD, integrated with Marigold CRM and Loyalty. Managed services for campaign creation, project management, creative, strategy, and tech. https://www.cheetahdigital.com/solutions/cheetah-experiences/		Realtime Media Full-service digital promotions and rewards with strategy and execution capabilities including sweepstakes, contests, instant win games, receipt validation, SMS, social, loyalty, legal/admin, and fulfillment services. Significant client overlap. https://www.rtm.com/		
	Snipp Started as a receipt validation platform and expanded into rebate and loyalty. Now positioned as Customer Acquisition, Retention, and Engagement (CARE) platform. https://www.snipp.com/		Cataboom Provider of out of the box gamification mechanics, as well as playable minigames as part of its Catapult platform. Heavily positions gamification as a loyalty driver. https://www.cataboom.com		
	Talon.One Started as an offer management platform, added referral and loyalty capabilities. Has recently been heavily marketing its gamification features and how they impact loyalty/purchase experiences. https://www.talon.one/		Brandmovers Full-service promotions and engagement platform including sweeps, instant win, contest, rebates, gift with purchase, receipt validation, advergames, legal, admin, and fulfillment. https://www.brandmovers.com/promotions		
	Don Jagoda Major competitor in administrative services – legal, winner experience, etc. – with a long tenure in the space (founded in 1962), plus templated games and development services. https://www.dja.com				
Key Alliances	We have a robust network of technology and service partners specific to promotions that allow us to expand our capabilities in areas like AR/VR, SaaS games, receipt validation, web3, social and UGC, and prizes/rewards. 				



OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games

Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY

As the only partner with 25 years of experience, creative rigor, and technical know-how, we create gamified experiences that delight and motivate people in a brand moment.

We know how to motivate human behavior, the best ways to spark excitement, and build enduring loyalty. Our approach combines game mechanics with motivational science to deliver compelling experiences rooted in data.

We're a fully integrated end-to-end services and tech promotions house, with:

- Gamification Consulting
- Strategy & Insights
- Legal Compliance
- Agile Program Management
- UX & Creative
- Gamification Experience Design
- Promotions & Loyalty Platforms
- Analytics
- Customer Service
- Prize Procurement & Fulfillment

OUR WORK



Burger King gamification tied to CRM & loyalty
[Link.com](#)



Starbucks drives a variety of behaviors year over year
[Link.com](#)



Albertson's drives purchase and digital acquisition
[Link.com](#)

MARKET VALIDATION



Loyalty Solutions Assessment Leader
2024



Forrester
Now Tech: Promotions And Offer Management Providers
2021



[“Why Burger King is all-in on gamification | Marketing Dive”](#)
Marketing Dive, 2024



Burger King Award
Tis the Cheeson Promotion
Loyalty360 AwardPlatinum for Customer Loyalty Strategy and Silver in Creative Campaign and Communications.

OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

CASE STUDIES

Include at least three case studies related to your offering. If you have cases already built out, feel free to include in this deck.

Client	Project	Market	Description	Outcomes
Starbucks	Starbucks Big 5 Case Study	QSR	A look at the multitude of ways Starbucks uses gamification to drive behavior across its consumer base	Purchase, engagement, acquisition, incrementality, loyalty
Burger King	Burger King Engagement Case Study	QSR	Gamification integrated with a robust CRM strategy has added heat to the brand's loyalty roll out, driving behavior in app and incrementality while boosting loyalty acquisition.	Acquisition, purchase, engagement, incrementality, loyalty
Albertsons	Flavor Adventure Case Study	Retail/Grocery	A closer look at the digital Flavor Adventure game that we created for Albertson's 22 banner as the result of a Gamification Blueprint and subsequent build.	Conversion, purchase, acquisition, digital behavior adoption

OFFERING

Gamification & Branded Games



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

GUIDANCE AND GUIDELINES

Gamification and games drive results for brands in many ways:

- Data collection and customer acquisition
- Incentivize behaviors like opt-in, trial, purchase, visit frequency, etc.
- Tie-in to new product launches or other brand "news"
- Habit creation to accompany new experiences or products
- Seasonally – during peak or slow times
- Tied to partnerships, sponsorships, co-op, events
- Around holidays and celebrations
- Increase engagement with social, CRM, loyalty, and POS
- Ongoing as part of a calendar of engagement touchpoints

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- "We need to capture more first- and zero-party data so we can build customer relationships and have better targeting."
- "We need to generate excitement around a new product/service."
- "We need to improve click-through from our media."
- "Our loyalty/CRM enrollment has slowed or plateaued"
- "We need to turn anonymous consumers into known so we can target them better."
- "We need to give customers a reason to engage with us (on social, our email newsletter, our app, etc.)."

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- What are the client's acquisition and data goals?
- What other KPIs are they hoping the promotion will help them grow/meet?
- What is the all-in budget, including prizing?
- How soon do they need something in market?
- Are there other partners involved (co-sponsors, retail + CPG shopper marketing, etc.)?
- Where will customers see the call to action? (In-store, owned channels, paid media, messaging, etc.)

OFFERING

Experiential Promotions



SME Contact

Have questions? Reach out to the offering owner or regional point person. They can help you present or tailor this content for your needs.

OWNER



Jen Gray
GM, Promotions &
Gamification / Creative

SME



Kinley Clifford
VP Head of Experience
Design Consulting,
Gamification & Loyalty



Caron Whitener
SVP, Client Services
Promotions & Loyalty

Internal: Launch quality checklist

Before publishing this offering, check the following is true and complete.

Delete this slide before publishing.

Content

☐	All sections complete	A sub \$100k engagement. You'll define, the project phases and deliverables, as well as guide pricing.
☐	Market Pricing Complete & Consistent	Pricing (per market if applicable) is complete and consistent. Double check overview slides match to timeline/pricing.
☐	Outcomes	Enablement and sales slides have information around outcomes (growth, efficiency, etc) and not just output (what we will deliver).
☐	Template	Content is in the proper Merkle template. All slides and fonts have been translated correctly into Merkle brand.

Structure & Presentation

☐	Clean slides	All comments deleted (not resolved), all content off slides removed
☐	Proper structure	Sales narrative (incl cases), engagement definitions, sales enablement, about the GTM.
☐	Hidden slides removed	All hidden slides have been removed from presentation version.
☐	User help	Labels used correctly to note internal/external slides, note versions (eg options or vertical-specific content), and other notes.
☐	Delete instruction slides	Ensure that all instructional slides and checklists (including this one) are deleted.

File Management

☐	On Merkle 5.1, create a 'Ready for Sharepoint' folder for the offering, and place a copy of the final file, correctly named, in the folder.
☐	File should be named: <i>Offering-Name-Offering-vX.X</i>'. If you are publishing a minor update, simply update the minor version.
☐	If a folder for the offering does not exist on the public Sharepoint, create one. COPY do not move the final file there.
☐	Update the value prop page and the all offerings pages with links to the offering folder.